Market Readiness Assistance (MRA) Grant — SMF Advisory Note

Internal advisory note for SMF member-facing officers. Summarised from Enterprise Singapore's published scheme page. Not legal or financial advice; final determination rests with EnterpriseSG.

Overview

The Market Readiness Assistance (MRA) grant helps Singapore SMEs expand into **new overseas markets** by defraying the costs of overseas market promotion, business development and market set-up. For SMF manufacturing members, MRA is the standard instrument for a first push into Indonesia, Vietnam, Malaysia, the Middle East or Europe — funding overseas trade fair participation, distributor identification, in-market business development and overseas incorporation costs.

Two significant changes as of 2026:

1. **From 1 April 2026, the SME support level was raised to up to 70%** (previously capped at 50%), as announced in Budget 2026. Per the Business Refresh Package factsheet, the higher support level is applicable **until 31 March 2029**.
2. **From 2H 2026, MRA is being folded into the new EDGE grant.** When EDGE is implemented, the "new market" criterion is to be **removed**, and eligibility is to be **extended to local non-SMEs at up to 50%** support. See `grant_edge_upcoming.md`.

Until EDGE launches, the existing MRA rules below apply.

What It Funds

MRA covers activities under three pillars, each with its own sub-cap:

- **Overseas market promotion** — capped at **S$20,000**
- **Overseas business development** — capped at **S$50,000**
- **Overseas market set-up** — capped at **S$30,000**

Supportable activities:

- **Overseas Marketing and PR Activities** — marketing/PR campaigns, in-store promotions, road shows, pop-up stores, social media presence development, online/offline media coverage.
- **Overseas Physical and Virtual Trade Fairs** — participation in overseas trade fairs. **MRA support is NOT provided for LEAD-supported trade fairs** (those are funded through a separate EnterpriseSG/TAC channel — relevant for SMF-organised missions).
- **Identification of Potential Overseas Partners** — licensees/franchisees, agents, distributors, JV partners, cross-border logistics partners.
- **In-market Business Development** — outsourced business development services overseas.
- **Overseas Marketing Presence** — deploying an employee overseas to conduct business development.
- **Market Entry** — advisory, legal and documentation expenses for IP application, overseas incorporation, and import/export licences.

The full list of supportable costs and sample deliverables is published at: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/-/media/esg/files/financial-assistance/grants/for-local-companies/market-readiness-assistance-grant/mra_supportable_activities.pdf

Eligibility

- Business entity registered and operating in Singapore.
- At least **30% local equity** held directly or indirectly by Singapore Citizens and/or PRs, determined by ultimate individual ownership.

- **New to the target overseas market** — the company's annual sales in that market **must not have exceeded S$100,000 in any of the preceding three years**.
- **Group annual sales turnover not exceeding S$100 million OR group employment size not exceeding 200 employees.**

Additional rules:

- **Each application is limited to one activity in a single overseas market.**
- Each project must not exceed **12 months**.
- Applications should be submitted **6 months or less before the project start date**.
- Retrospective applications are not permitted — the project must not have started, no payment made, and no contract signed with the consultant/vendor prior to submission.
- Group applications are not allowed.

Funding Support

- **Up to 70% of eligible costs for local SMEs** (effective 1 April 2026; previously up to 50%).
- **Capped at S$100,000 per company per new market**, subject to the three pillar sub-caps above.
- **Audit cost:** all MRA claims are subject to audit. Audit cost starts from **S$200** depending on scope, and is supported at **up to 50%, capped at S$500**. Project and audit costs fall under the same pillar cap. *Note: EnterpriseSG's page states the audit support as "up to 50% capped at S$500" while also carrying the 70% enhancement footnote — **TO VERIFY** **whether audit cost support was also raised to 70% from 1 April 2026.***

How to Apply

1. **Identify the target overseas market** and confirm sales there have not exceeded S$100,000 in any of the last three years.
2. **Identify the activity and select a vendor** (not required for Overseas Marketing Presence projects).
3. **Prepare documents:** financial statements for the past 3 years (plus group statements/ACRA bizfiles/group structure if part of a corporate group); the vendor/consultant proposal or quotation with detailed scope, expected deliverables and cost breakdown, addressed to the exact ACRA-registered name; and the vendor's credentials, testimonials and past project track record (not required for EnterpriseSG's list of FTA and Trade Compliance consultants). For Overseas Marketing Presence, additionally provide the BD staff's employment/appointment letter and an office space rental quotation if applicable.
4. **Apply on the Business Grants Portal (BGP)** via Corppass. Third parties may not apply or manage the grant.
5. **Processing takes approximately 8–12 weeks.**
6. **Accept the Letter of Offer** and complete the project, achieving all stated deliverables. Submit a change request on BGP for any change to project dates, claim due date, project costs or vendor.
7. **Complete the audit** using an auditor from EnterpriseSG's Pre-Qualified Panel.
8. **Submit the claim** on BGP with the audit report, auditor-endorsed Statement of Claim, and evidence of deliverables.
9. **Disbursement** ~14 working days via PayNow Corporate; up to eight weeks via GIRO.

For Overseas Marketing Presence claims, additional evidence is required: the BD staff's employment letter and payslips/CPF statements, plus either a passport photocopy showing entry/exit dates from the market or a residential/long-term hotel lease agreement.

Common Pitfalls

- **Applying for a market the member already sells into.** The S$100,000 / three-year test is strict and is checked against financial records.
- **Applying for a LEAD-supported trade fair.** SMF officers should cross-check the LEAD event list before advising a member to apply — many of the fairs SMF itself organises or supports may fall under LEAD.

- **Bundling two activities or two markets in one application.** One activity, one market, per application.
- **Signing the vendor contract before applying.** Disqualifies the application.
- **Forgetting the audit.** Unlike PSG, every MRA claim requires an external audit by a pre-qualified panel auditor, and members must budget for it.
- **Exceeding a pillar sub-cap** while still being under the S$100,000 overall cap. The sub-caps bind first.
- **Applying more than 6 months ahead** of the project start date.

Source & Last Verified

- Primary source: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/financial-support/market-readiness-assistance-grant
- Business Refresh Package factsheet (Mar 2026): https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/-/media/esg/files/media-centre/media-releases/2026/march/mr00826_business-refresh-package.pdf
- FAQ: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/resources/all-faqs/market-readiness-assistance-grant
- **Last verified: 26 July 2026.**